
The Good and the Bad Architect

Media + Differentiation

Professional Practice 1

Helen Duong + Peter Brew | RMIT Architecture

The Good + the Bad Architect - Adolf Loos
Similarities rather than Differences
Specialisation + Awards
Power Relations
Research Efforts
The Future of the Profession
Conclusions + Observations

May I take you to the shores of a mountain lake? The sky is blue, the water green and everywhere is profound tranquillity. The clouds and mountains are mirrored in the lake, the **houses**, **farms**, and **chapels** as well. They do not look as if they were fashioned by man, it is as if they came straight from God's workshop, like the mountains and trees, the clouds and the blue sky.

And everything exudes an air of beauty and peace...

But what is this? A discordant note in the tranquillity. Like an unnecessary screech. Among the locals' houses, that were not built by them, but by God, stands a **villa**. The creation of an architect. Whether a good or bad architect, I don't know. All I know is that the tranquillity, peace and beauty have vanished.

Before God there are no good or bad architects, in His presence all architects are equal. In the cities, in the presence of Belial, there are subtle nuances, as is the nature of vice. And

**therefore I ask, why is it that any architect,
good or bad, desecrates the lake.**

The Good + the Bad Architect - Adolf Loos

Since there are buildings in good and bad taste, people assume the former are designed by artists, the latter by non-artists. But building in good taste should be just as much a matter of course as not putting your knife in your mouth or cleaning your teeth in the morning. People are here confusing art and culture. Can you show me one piece of bad taste from past times, that is from a cultured age?

Adolf Loos - Architecture Essay 1910

Architecture

Artist

Culture

Taste

Collective

Individual

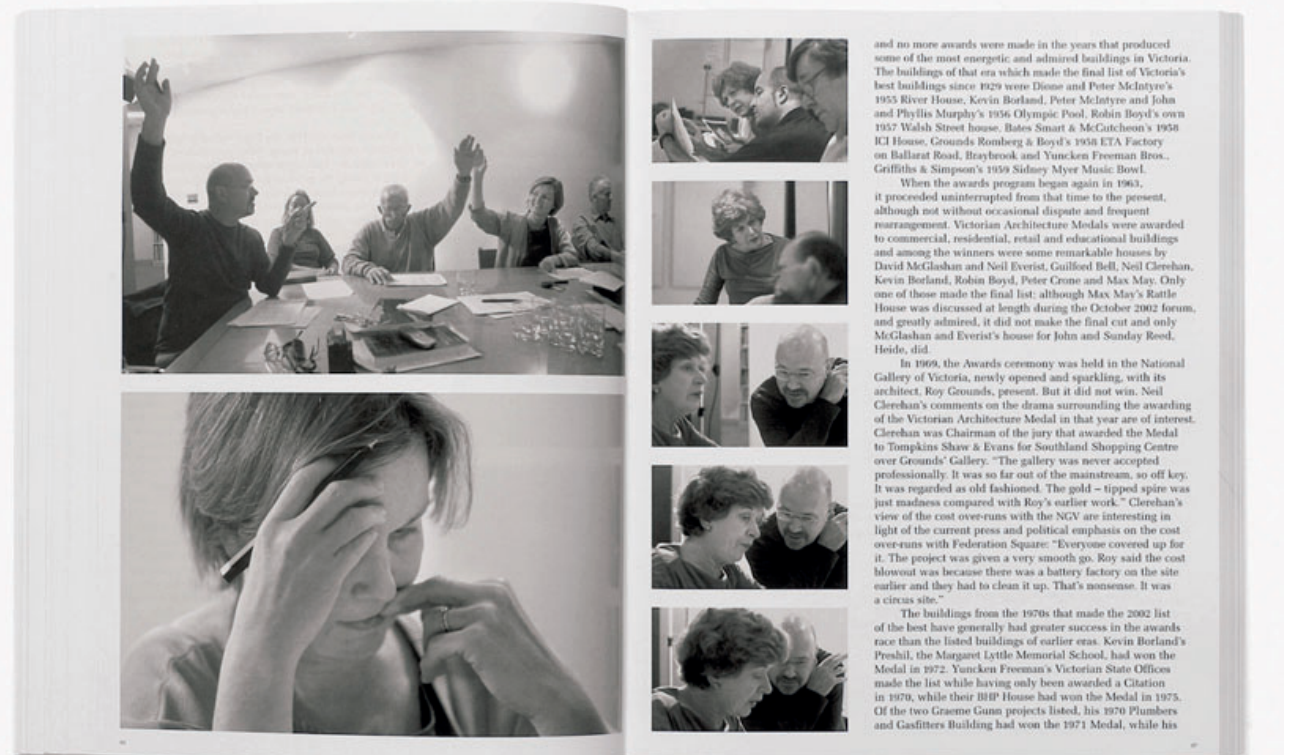
Everyday

Bespoke

The Good + the Bad Architect - Adolf Loos



"Judging Architecture, Issues Divisions Triumphs. Victorian Architecture Awards 1929 - 2003"



Specialisation + Awards

Individual	Collective
10 Qualifications for registration as an architect A natural person is eligible to be registered as an architect if the person— (a) is of good character; and (b) has been engaged for not less than 2 years on practical architectural work and has attained a standard of professional practice satisfactory to the Board; and	To be consistent with other architects Division 5—Duties to the public and the profession 17 Duty to engender confidence and respect for the profession An architect, by the architect's conduct, must endeavour to engender confidence in and respect for the profession of architecture. 18 Duty to maintain standards and integrity of the profession An architect, by the architect's conduct, must endeavour to maintain the standards and integrity of the profession of architecture.

Persona- Individual & Collective

Extracts from the Architects Act & Regulations

Similarities rather than Differences



Australian Institute Architects Categories

Commercial Architecture
 Educational Architecture
 Heritage Architecture
 Interior Architecture
 Public Architecture
 Residential Architecture – Houses (New)
 Residential Architecture – Houses (Alterations and Additions)
 Residential Architecture – Multiple Housing
 Small Project Architecture
 Urban Design
 Sustainable Architecture
 Colourbond Award for Steel Architecture
 Enduring Architecture
 Emerging Architect Prize
 EmAGN Project Award
 Regional Prize
 Melbourne Prize
 Bates Smart Award for Architecture in Media

Are these different
 Architectures? Or are they
 different business models,
 marketing strategies?

Specialisation + Awards



Victoria

Journal of the Royal Victorian Institute of
Architects. 1929-1942
National Library of Australia.

**Professional record
Institute organisation**



New South Wales

Art and Architecture,
vol. 5 (1908)

**Public culture art
architectural discourse**

Professional record, public culture or reputation?



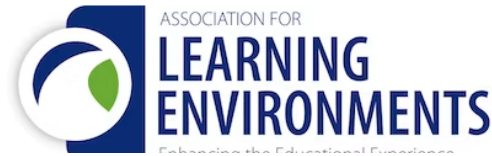
Victorian Architecture Awards Policy

6.0 Victorian Architecture Medal

- 6.1 The winner of the Victorian Architecture Medal is judged to be the **most outstanding project of the entire field of entries, a building of exceptional merit** in respect of the Core Evaluation Criteria as defined in the Entry and Jury Handbooks.
- 6.2 The Medal is awarded from the Named Award winners from all national direct-entry categories and Sustainable Architecture and COLORBOND® Award for Steel Architecture, as well as the winners of the Melbourne Prize and Regional Prize.
- 6.3 The jury shall be comprised of the Chair of Juries and a jury representative from all national direct-entry categories as well as Sustainable Architecture, COLORBOND® Award for Steel Architecture, Melbourne Prize and Regional Prize.
- 6.4 In the first instance, each category representative shall be the respective jury chair.
 - 6.4.1 If a jury chair cannot attend the selection meeting, they may nominate a proxy from their jury to attend.
 - 6.4.2 If a jury chair – or their practice – has a project shortlisted in the Victorian Architecture Awards, they may remain in the meeting during discussion of that category provided their project was not the overall category winner. The Chair of Juries shall remind all jurors to maintain strict confidentiality at all times including with their practice colleagues.
 - 6.4.3 If a jury chair – or their practice – has a project which is an overall category winner in the Victorian Architecture Awards, they shall be required to send a proxy from their jury in their place. The proxy shall be the juror who has been registered as an architect for the greatest number of years provided they are not also conflicted.
- 6.5 The Medal selection meeting shall be chaired by the Chair of Juries. Each jury representative will present their category winner providing application text, entry images and drawings. Site visits will not take place for the purposes of selecting the Medal.

"Building of exceptional merit"

"Most outstanding project"



ALL CATEGORIES (except for the innovation category, see below):

Criteria A - Planning Process:

As described above.

Criteria B - Design Outcome:

Provide evidence that the architectural design meets the requirements of the educational brief with a special emphasis on the educational value of the space.

[250 words max]

Criteria C - Flexibility:

Provide evidence of the unique functionality of the design as well as its responsiveness to changes in the educational program.

[250 words max]

Criteria D - Innovation:

Your description could include evidence of innovative design solutions; value for money; design elements and sustainability.

[250 words max]

INNOVATION EDUCATION INITIATIVE :

The Innovative Education Initiative category award will be presented to the entrant whose project best meets the following criteria. [All criteria equally weighted]

Criteria A - Planning Process:

As described above.

Criteria E - Innovative Program:

Evidence that the education initiative challenges and transforms the role that educational facilities play in the learning process.

[250 words max]

Criteria F - Innovative Approach:

Evidence that the education initiative introduces innovative ideas or approaches to current practices in the development of educational facilities and aims to inform the field of educational facility planning.

[250 words max]

Criteria G - Innovative Use:

Evidence that the education initiative demonstrates innovative use of an educational facility by educators and students and/or members of the community. Include any evidence of improved educational experiences for students.

[250 words max]

Post-occupancy evaluation

Evidence from users and learning
outcomes

What does the award ask us to see?



Pascoe Vale Primary School — Kosloff
Architecture

**AIA: Henry Bastow Award for
Educational Architecture
Professional exemplar.**



Scientia Terrace, Monte Sant' Angelo
Mercy College — Hayball

**LEA: Overall Winner ·
Educational impact
+ post-occupancy evidence.**

What does the award ask us to see?

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← BACK TO PRACTICE

Indigenizing practice: To award, or not to award?

In the first of a series of discussions on Indigenizing architectural practice in Australia, Sarah Lynn Rees speaks to practitioners about the place and process of Indigenous awards. The intent of this series is to raise awareness and integrate Indigenous material, conversations and perspectives into the content and themes explored in *Architecture Australia*.



Sarah Lynn Rees at the 2019 National Architecture Conference. Image: Jackson Clements Burrows



by Sarah Lynn Rees
10 Nov 2020

📄 📱 📧 📧

As the architecture profession engages more and more with Indigenous peoples across Australia, we are seeing an increase in projects labelled “Indigenous architecture” entered into awards programs. However, the current Australian Institute of Architects awards system and its assessment criteria weren’t necessarily written to account for Indigenous engagement, perspectives and approaches to design. As a result, we risk awarding projects for which the engagement process or outcomes may not be appropriate in the eyes of the Indigenous community representatives who were engaged on the projects. This is especially problematic because awarded projects sit on the permanent record of what we collectively consider and portray to the world as precedents of “good design.”

Here, a diverse range of Indigenous and non-Indigenous practitioners and awards convenors, as well as our Māori colleagues, respond to questions about awarding Indigenous architecture.

Should there be an Indigenous Architecture award?

Most read



Design for “talent” residential towers in Sydney approved



Vale John Simpson 1936-2020



Transformation of Sydney heritage department store into mixed-use tower development complete

Latest on site



Concept unveiled for new tower within Brisbane's James Street precinct

Louis Anderson Mokak: I think we all agree that a shift needs to occur whereby what the profession actually determines as “good architecture” has a criticality that involves the voices of Indigenous peoples [and] that is not exclusionary and does not perpetuate western thought and dominance.

I see the incentive in creating an Indigenous award. But what I’m more interested in is how we can lift the benchmark and hold all practitioners to account across the whole profession; to look at the actual means of how Indigenous cultures and knowledge systems are valued, respected and embedded across the board – within all projects, typologies, programs and awards categories.

What is the strategy around setting a different process of awarding architecture? Is the shift made through an Indigenous award or through having Indigenous knowledge systems and values embedded within all sets of criteria in all architecture awards categories? I like to think that the profession can do it through the latter.

I know that there will be different opinions. However, what is imperative is that First Nations peoples and cultures do not become alienated through this process, and that power and benefit does not lie within the dominant role of the architect. For too long, our voices have not been centred and valued. We need to be in the foreground and to have true voice.

Rory Hyde, “The Robin Boyd Award for Ambitious Architecture,” *Architecture Australia*, 2011

A separate award — or a different standard for all awards?

chitecture, Au
ard for
ial Impact

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o in touch

My dashboard



Architecture, Au Award for Social Impact

Good design
doing good

Winner revealed!

The ArchitectureAu Award for Social Impact recognises projects that promote the common good. It has been conceived to reward practice that preferences empathy over aesthetics, extending the spatial possibilities of architecture to advance the discipline and to empower its users. Projects may relate to social cohesion, racial justice, inclusive housing, accessibility, equity, social sustainability or other areas where design can make a difference to society. This accolade is the only national recognition of this type of work within Australia.

The award criteria focus on demonstrable social benefit and the quality and originality of the design thinking that delivered it. Practices of all types and scale may enter. A broad array of work is eligible, but submissions must be connected in some way to Australian architecture and the built environment. Applicants may include architects, interior designers, planners, landscape architects, urban designers and other built environment professionals. Projects must be built, not speculative.

Criteria

2024	David Fisher—Juror	Chief Executive Officer, Housing Choices Australia
	Maryam Gusheh—Juror	Associate Professor in Architecture, Monash University
	Elizabeth Watson-Brown MP LFRAIA—Juror	Member for Ryan
	Kieran Wong—Juror	Partner, The Fulcrum Agency
	Linda Cheng—Juror	Editor, ArchitectureAu.com
2023	Rory Hyde—Jury Convenor	Melbourne School of Design University of Melbourne
	Troy Casey—Juror	Director, Blaklash Creative
	Esther Charlesworth AM—Juror	Professor of Architecture, RMIT, and Founder of Architects Without Frontiers
	Ben Gauntlett—Juror	Disability Discrimination Commissioner, Australian Human Rights Commission
	Jeremy McLeod—Juror	Founder, Breathe
	Katelin Butler—Juror	Editorial Director, Architecture Media
	Rory Hyde—Jury Convenor	Melbourne School of Design University of Melbourne

Jury

A separate award — or a different standard for all awards?

8/9/26, 11:00 PM 1985: The year in review | ArchitectureAu

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← BACK TO ARCHIVE

1985: The year in review

From the archives of *Architecture Australia*, a 1985 article in which Don Bailey discusses the merits of architecture awards, and Philip Cox reviews two major exhibitions: *Old Continent*, *New Buildings* and *Australia Built*.

Architecture Awards – Quo Vadis?

by Philip Cox

Don Bailey
21 Oct 2012

Don Bailey

The National Architecture Awards are now in the fifth year of operation. In terms of resource allocation, the awards presently constitute the largest single Australian Institute of Architects programme intended to focus community attention on architecture, and architectural excellence. Through attainment of wide media exposure regionally and nationally, the awards programme is intended to promote public participation in a celebration of architecture.

No doubt a very large proportion of the public remain disinterested in such overtures and retain a very cynical view of the whole awards process. The public generally takes the view that awards are a self-congratulatory process – a kind of corporate narcissism – whereby architects are being seen to pontificate on what is good architecture, without apparent concern for the views of the average person. This is not unlike the well-known jibe at the arrogance of the medical profession – “The operation was a resounding success. Incidentally, the patient died!”

At the professional level, the awards system is intended to sharpen critical judgement, promote debate of differing ideologies, and throw into relief the current state of the art.

A section of the profession also shares a very cynical view of the awards process. This group takes the view that the system is designed to glorify the work of a vocal minority of practitioners, and would have us believe that the jury appointments tend to perpetuate certain fashions within architecture and do little good in setting high standards in the fullest sense of architectural practice, for the profession to live up to.

Most read

- Design for “tallest” residential towers in Sydney approved
- Yale John Simpson 1938–2026
- Transformation of Sydney heritage department store into mixed-use tower development complete

Latest on site

- Concept unveiled for new tower within Brisbane’s James Street precinct
- New McConnell restaurant opens with ACME design

https://architectureau.com/articles/the-year-in-retrospect-some-personal-views/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

1985: Don Baily, The year In review. i
Architecture,” Architecture Australia,

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Our charge is to bring the community into our confidence. The awards programme is one of the means to achieving this objective. May it never be seen as a vehicle for encouraging and perpetuating a clique of architectural prima donnas but rather a mechanism to portray architects as quietly competent facilitators.

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Awards should recognise public value

In Response: Rachel Hurst and review the standings of the 201 Awards

Rachel Hurst and Rory Hyde review the standings of the 2011 National Awards.



In 2010, Sarah Murdoch announced the wrong winner on *Australia's Next Top Model*.
Image: Still image from "Australia's Next Top Model"

on budget. They are not by unestablished or untested practices; they are not untested building types that don't fit neatly into categories; they are not buildings that might have a great front but a less effective rear. These awards celebrate refinement, and punish flaws; they celebrate success, not ambitious attempts.

Awarded projects should exemplify the particular values we believe architecture should embody, and can even act as a means to encourage these values in the future. By recognizing buildings that are very polite to their context, awards can encourage an architecture that doesn't shout, but which does its duty in the background. By recognizing cheap buildings that manage to scratch out an idea or presence greater than their constituent parts, awards can encourage an architecture that is nimble and smart.

Rory Hyde, "The Robin Boyd Award for Ambitious Architecture," Architecture Australia, 2011

Awards can turn existing visibility into further professional advantage

Making it into the pages of Architecture Australia has always been a major milestone – for architects and writers alike. Often, it happens only once in a career. More often, it doesn't happen at all. Appearing in this magazine has meant, or at least has felt like, being **written into** Australian architectural history.

≡ Architecture, Au

Mag

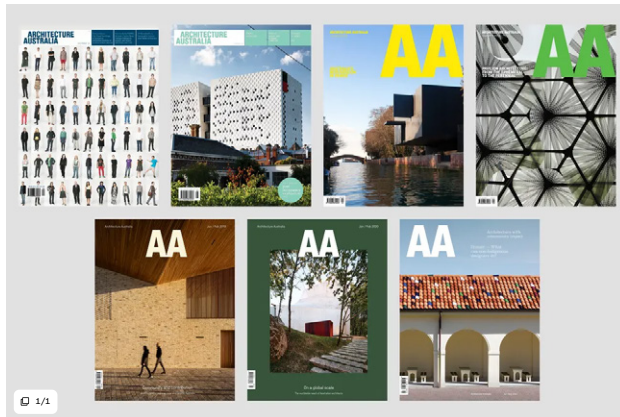
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by Naomi Stead | Products | Projects | Interiors | Insights | Awards | Calendar | Jobs

27 May 2024
← BACK TO DISCUSSION

Architecture Australia turns 120

Naomi Stead ponders the shifts that have occurred – in the magazine profession and in the world – since Architecture Australia's centenary 20 years ago.



The covers of Architecture Australia over the past 20 years. Image: collage by Tom Grant

Naomi Stead, "Architecture Australia turns 120,"
Architecture Australia, 2024

Has AA addressed these blind spots in the intervening period? Some, but not all. It's still rare to see student work in the magazine; and while "ESD" is now more of a given precondition than a special category, the bias against "**pictorially unsexy**" work continues – including almost the entire genre of industrial architecture, plus much other work that is modest, unspectacular or hard to photograph. On the other hand, the

But has the magazine reflected major events taking place in the world? Only kinda. In the volumes of the past 20 years, AA often feels like a **walled garden** – inured and isolated from the events of the nation and especially the wider world. Consider important events in Australia's social history over this period: the Cronulla riots, the apology to the Stolen Generations, the Black Saturday bushfires, Julia Gillard's election, the introduction of the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS), the release of the Uluru Statement from the Heart ... There are some passing references, but overall, these events might have occurred in another world, outside of this oddly floating parallel universe. Of course, AA is not a current affairs journal. It's in the nature of a professional magazine to be more of a searchlight than a lantern, and AA's beam is strongly directed when it comes to current concerns within the profession.

Media makes the canon-Who gets written into history?

Media channel	Gatekeeper	What it rewards	Critical risk
Awards	Institutions and juries	Professionally recognised “excellence”	Prestige circulates among practices able to enter, document and promote work
Architectural journals	Editors, critics and publishers	Select projects, strong photography and architectural argument	Criticism and professional promotion become difficult to separate
Online design media	Editors, submissions and web traffic	Novelty, visual impact and rapid circulation	Architecture becomes globally visible but detached from local and social context
Practice website and PR	The practice or its publicist	A consistent portfolio and brand narrative	Marketing claims appear without independent evaluation
Instagram and TikTok	Algorithms and audience behaviour	Images, personality, frequency, novelty and engagement	Popularity becomes a proxy for architectural value
LinkedIn	Professional networks and algorithms	Business success, leadership and professional persona	Individual authority is produced through visibility and repetition

Editorial selection to platform visibility

BATESSMART™

Award for Architecture in the Media

The Bates Smart Award for Architecture in the Media is Australia's most prestigious media award for journalists, editors, producers and event organisers working in the field of architecture and design. It is an annual award to encourage and to recognise media discussion of architecture.

Established in 1986 the Award has become an integral part of the Australian Institute of Architects annual Awards Program in Victoria with Bates Smart sponsoring the Award since its inception.

The Bates Smart Award for Architecture in the Media is designed to increase public engagement and media exposure of the work of the profession, as well as encouraging high-quality debate about architecture in Australia.

The Award recognises the role and contribution of people who:

- bring architecture to the attention of the general public
- create awareness of architectural practice
- generate quality public debate about architectural issues and,
- provide information for relevant professionals and specialists in the areas of architecture, interior design and environmental design.

What is architecture media for?

AUSTRALIAN INDIGENOUS

DESIGN CHARTER - Communication Design

Protocols for sharing Indigenous knowledge in communication design practice

Indigenous Architecture and Design Victoria (IADV)

Design Institute of Australia (DIA)

Deakin University - Institute of Koorie Education (IKE)

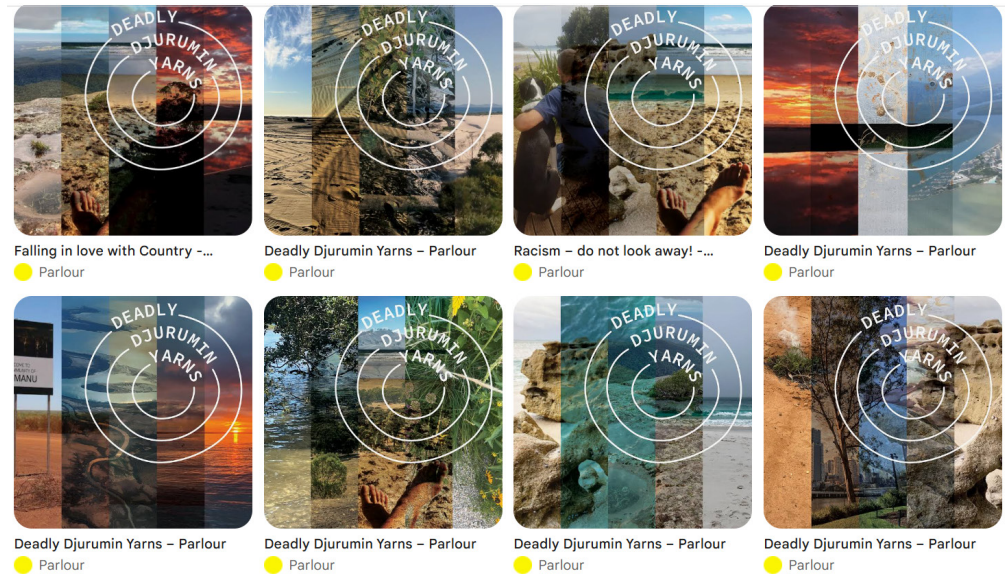
- School of Communication and Creative Arts (SCCA)



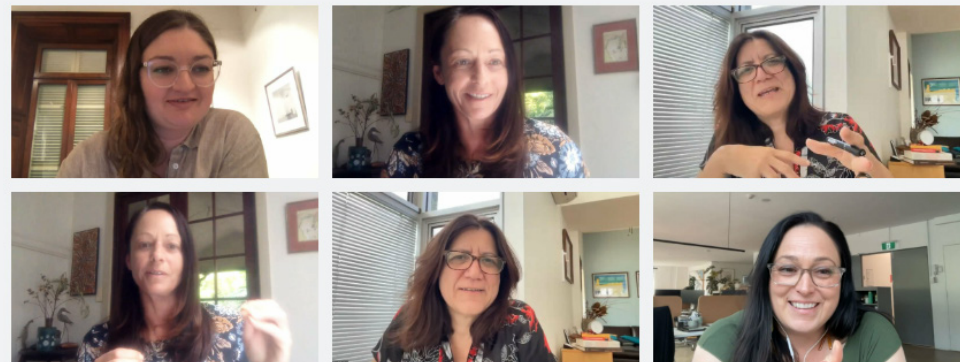
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Indigenous Design Charter

**Bates Smart Media National
Award 2023 Winner**

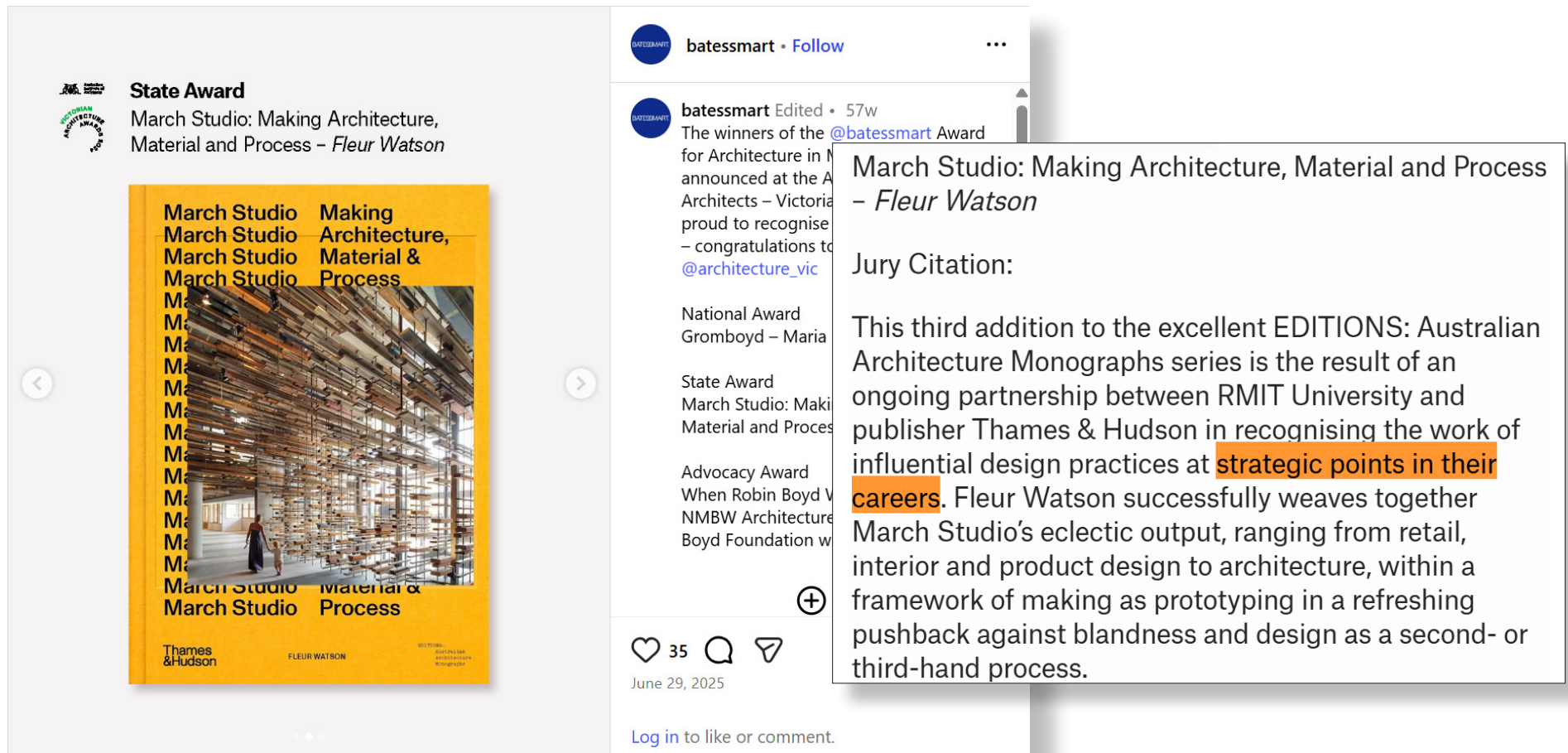


Watch [Sarah Lynn Rees](#) as she yarns with [Carroll Go-Sam](#) and Siân Hromek about what all this means, and what practitioners and researchers can do.



Deadly Djurumin Yarns- Parlour

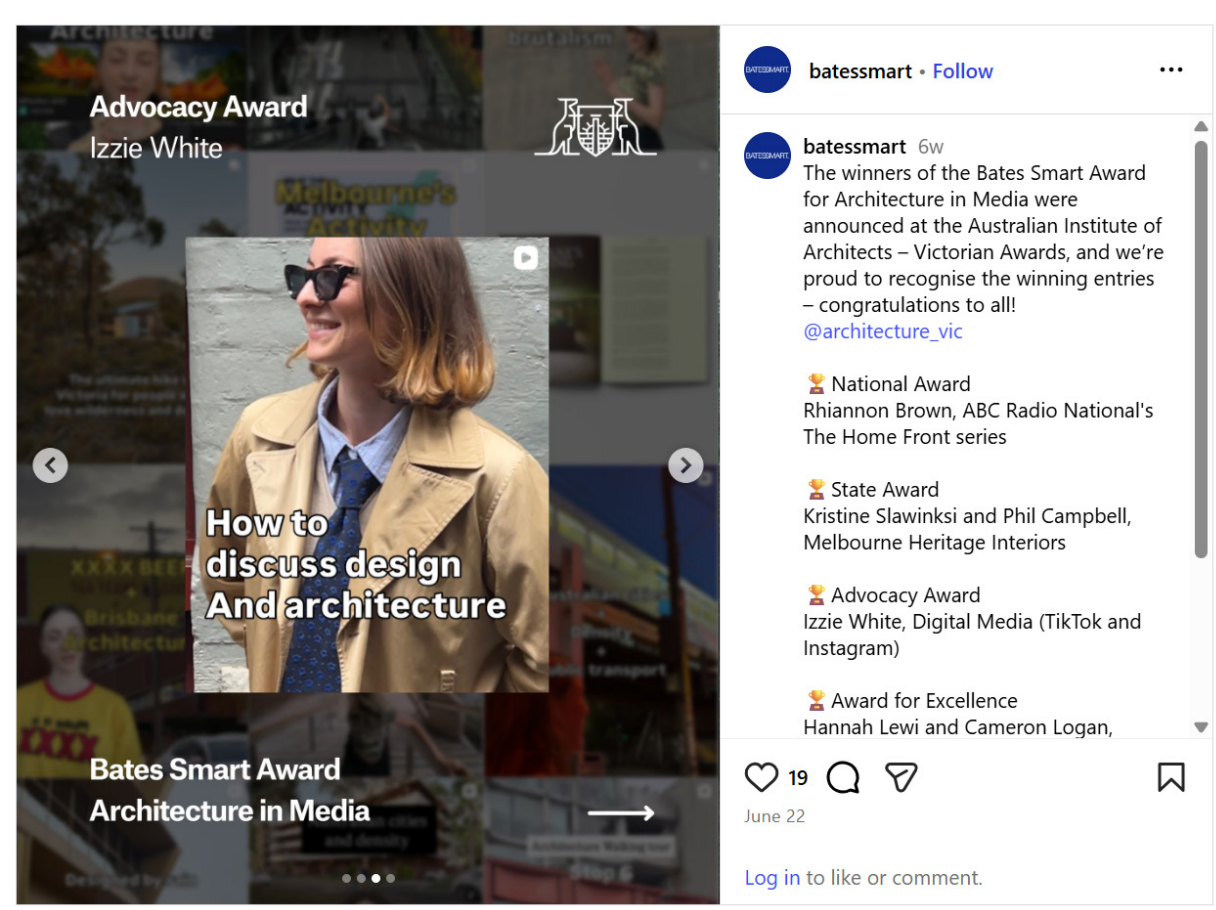
Media can redistribute authority + build collective
professional capacity



Bates Smart Media National
Award 2023 Winner

**Public culture art
architectural discourse**

Media can consolidate status



Izzie White – 2026 Bates Smart Advocacy Award
TikTok and Instagram on architecture, planning
and housing.
Almost 50,000 followers

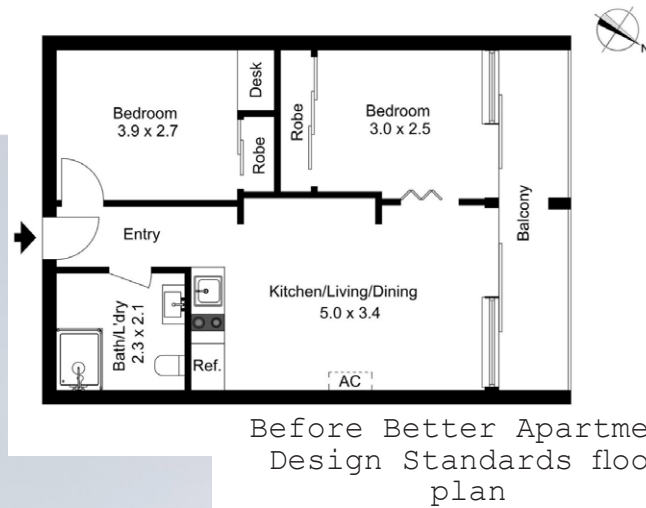
**Social media: advocacy,
personal brand—or both?**

Media can reward circulation



2011 Victorian Architecture Award
Best Overend Award for Resident
Architecture - Multiple Housing

A'Beckett Tower, 2011



Beyonce Body inspired
Tower - Premier Tower



We want to see your original Instagram photos of Elenberg Fraser buildings and projects. To enter simply follow (at)Elenberg_Fraser, tag our account in the photo and use the #elenbergfraser hashtag for your photo to be eligible. If you don't know where to start, click the 'read more' link below to visit the competition page on our website where you can download a map highlighting Elenberg Fraser's projects in the greater Melbourne area.

What's in it for you? Your efforts will not go unrewarded: the winner of the best original photograph (as chosen by Elenberg Fraser Director Callum Fraser) will receive a prize of a \$500 dining voucher for Vue De Monde.



Instagram There's no denying architects are visual creatures – whether butterpaper sketches or 3D renders, we're all about feasting our eyes. With that in mind, you won't be surprised to hear we've developed quite an affection for Instagram – well, what doesn't look better with a vintage filter? Now we want you to join in the fun and unleash your visual creature by entering Elenberg Fraser's first annual Instagram competition.

What does media promote?

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← BACK TO ARCHIVE

National President's foreword: Architecture Australia, November 1999

As we celebrate the last state and national Awards events of the 20th Century, I am prompted by the question: 'are we seen as a profession, or as a collection of talented individuals?' The question arises from the way in which we promote ourselves especially using architecture awards. Of course we are talented people who contribute to the winning of awards, but the real winners will always be out clients and the public; the ultimate owners of our ideas. These are the real beneficiaries of the solutions that we provide to their problems.

Following this line, it has been suggested to me that architecture awards be the provinces of clients. They should be celebrated not only for their commitment and vision, but also for their selection of the architect in this way the value of the relationship between parties takes on an expanded meaning; the client recognises the architect and design by nominating their project for an architecture award. After all, it is the client who defines the ultimate scope of a project.

It is not unusual however for the architect to have the ability to give the client confidence to proceed what a partnership; and what a responsibility. Are we educated for such a responsibility? Architecture education could see 'design' as a conclusion to a process rather than a beginning. Design will come out of sound briefing, learning to listen, process management and risk management. Design will come from a sound understanding of business principles related to that of our clients and our own business, from a greater understanding of politics, culture, economics and environment. The role of education, through a rigorous intellectual foundation, is to promote the ability to adapt to change. The profession must re engage an internship process that enhances this foundation through a skill base, and the RAIA must engage in continuing professional development programs that respond to changing needs.

Stepping back from Awards for a moment, I propose that the community does not see 'Architecture', it sees Architects; individuals who possess certain skills. The thought of engaging an intellectual could be threatening, and it may be that the subject of 'Architecture' is

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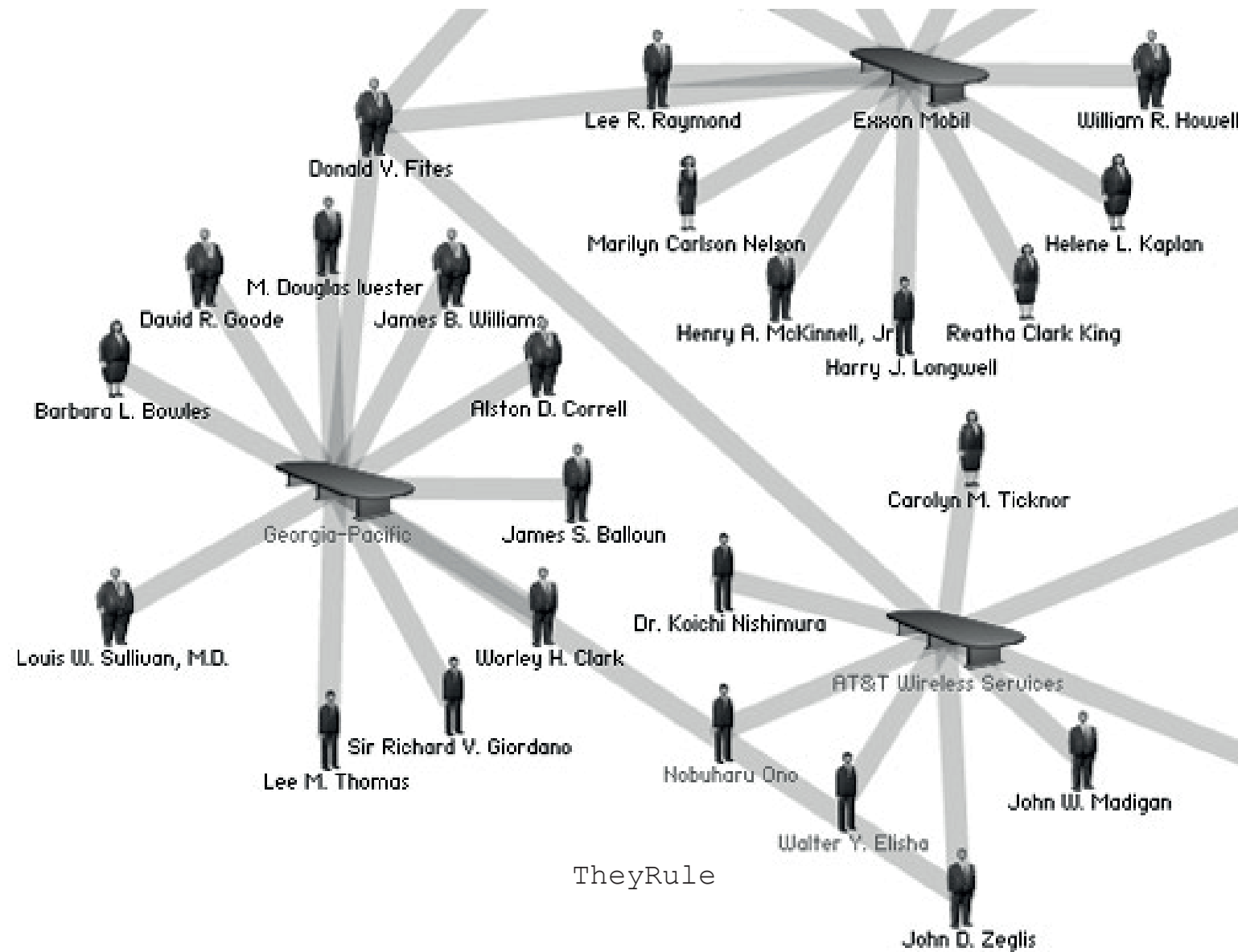
We must move forward with a positive view on the value of Architecture, not Architects as individuals; that will follow. In the lead up to the National Awards, questions have been raised regarding the Jury processes. It is always appropriate to revisit Policy, and we should expect this. It is far less appropriate to challenge the integrity of Jury decisions, even if they fly in the face of Policy. I expect that we will continue to be rigorous in our selection of Juries, and then trust to them the difficult task of assessing design excellence, and making (these) Awards.

Michael Hauer

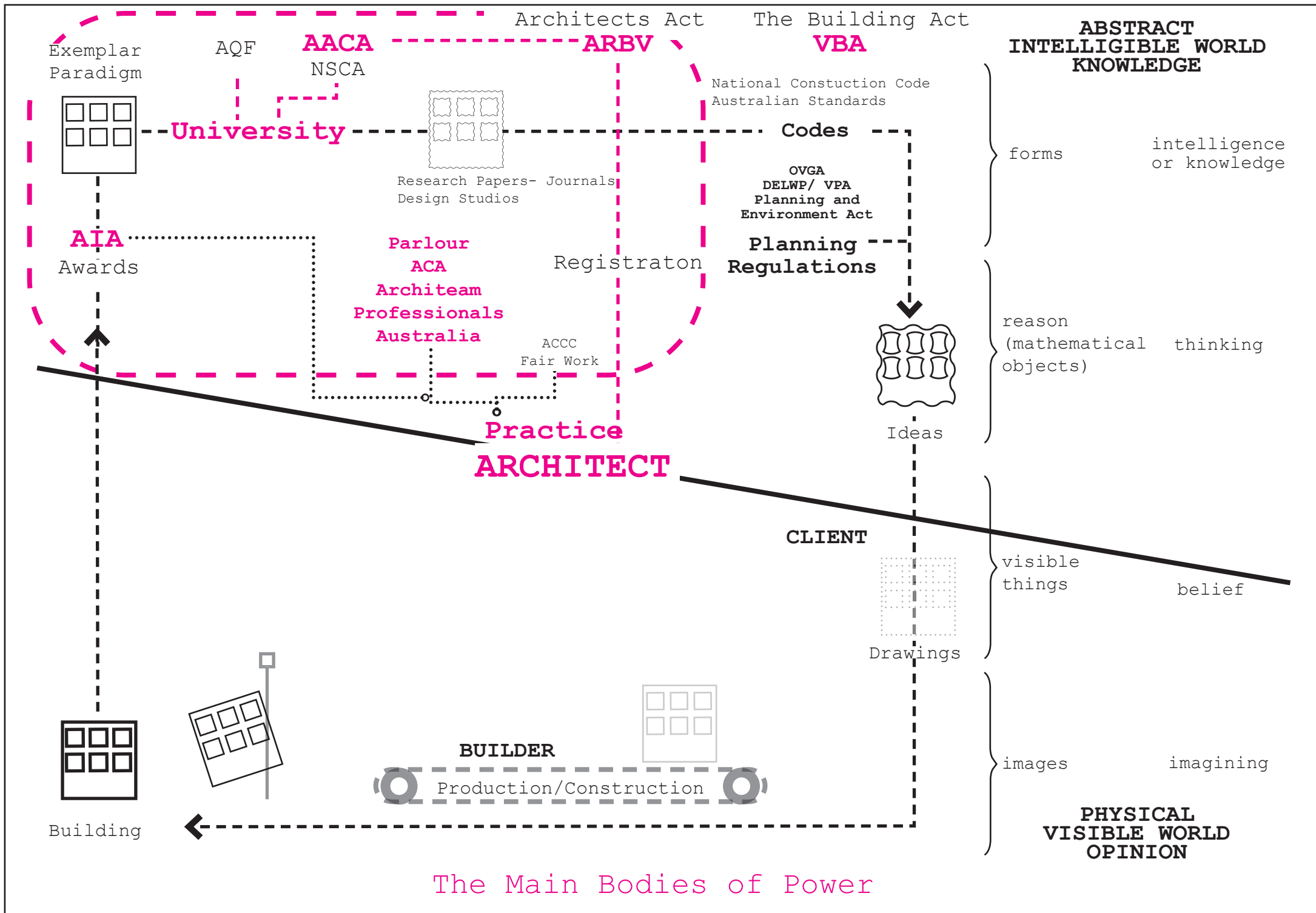
Stepping back from Awards for a moment, I propose that the community does not see 'Architecture', it sees Architects; individuals who possess certain skills. The thought of engaging an intellectual could be threatening, and it may be that the subject of 'Architecture' is never raised at all during a commission. So it is that as skills become blurred by change, or demonstrated by para-professionals, or even by clients themselves, the value of what we do is constantly questioned, even to the extent that the value of being educated in Architecture is taunted.

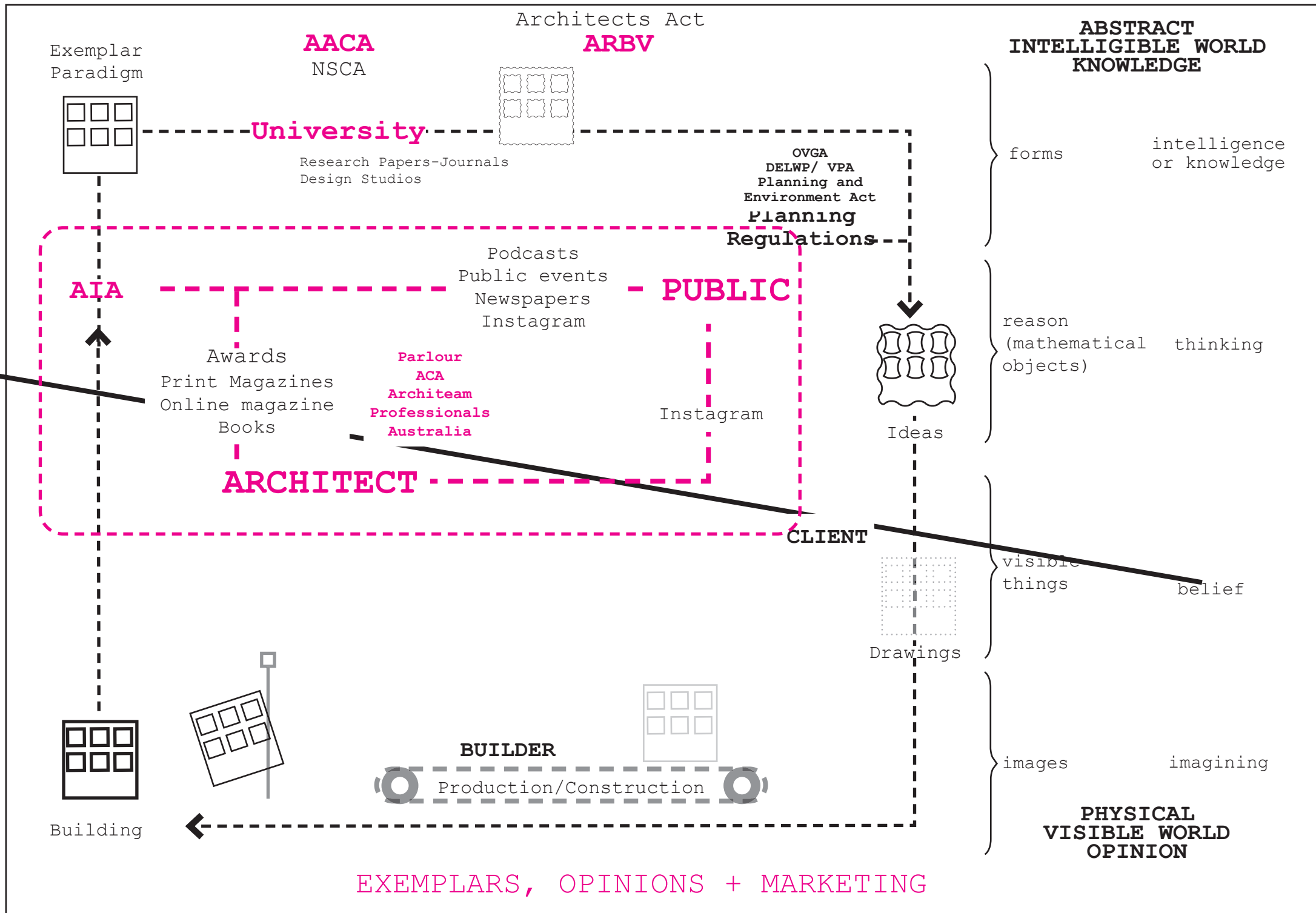
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Architecture, not architects



Power Relations





PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE 1

INNOVATION

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE 2



What Architecture is...

What Architecture does...

FIT FOR
PURPOSE



How Architecture is made...

How Architecture performs...

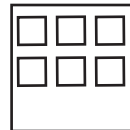
MANUFACTURED
BUILT



Traditional method of
representation and production...

New Description
of....

PUBLIC PERCEPTION
OF WHAT WE DO
IE.DRAWING



- new geometry
- new design tools
- new construction
- communication

National tourist road - Liasanden stop point - Jensen & Skodvin

What Architecture is...

Carpark

FIT FOR
PURPOSE

How Architecture
is made...

MANUFACTURED
BUILT

Traditional method of
representation and
production...

PUBLIC PERCEPTION
OF WHAT WE DO
IE. DRAWING

The site contours,
the material
properties have
architecture, which
these architects
have recognised

New Description

- new geometry
- new design tools
- new construction
- communication

How Architecture
performs...

Provides level
surface for cars and
protects trees

What Architecture does...

Reflects the landscape

